Mid-Program Review

The 360° of Program Management

Bosch

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Introduction

Participant Name: Hamsa N (MS/ECE-PN1-XC)

Manager Name : Prakash Praveen (MS/ECE-PN1-XC)

Role: Senior Project Manager

Function/Department: MS/ECE-PN1-XC

What is your job role? What activities does it involve?

- TPjM for Ford 48V project.
- Activities involve – responsible to direct the project team with regard to technical and product issues. Project planning and definition – technical resource planning and estimation, Risk Mgmt, Issue resolution, Data Quality & status reporting. Is responsible for R&D budget.

Who is your customer? (e.g. Internal teams or external clients)

- Customer – FORD
- Internal Stakeholders - Project team (SW/SYS, Safety, Testing, Quality, ASPICE)
- External Stakeholders - FORD Customer, Suppliers for sample ordering

Module-wise Learning Application

Modules		Been able to apply	Identified areas to apply	No Scope to apply
Leadership	Leader in me	✓		
	Resilient Leadership	✓		
	Uncertainty Management	✓		
	Strategic Thinking & Creativity		✓	
Professional	Leading Cross-functional teams	✓		
	Negotiation Skills/Conflict Management		✓	

Leaders in Me

THE SITUATION:

- **Incident:** Planned resources from our Ford Projects are reassigned to other high-priority MB and GM projects.
- **Reduced Workforce:** Sudden loss of key project personnel.
- **Slippage Risk:** High probability of milestone and deliverable delays.
- **Visibility:** This "Event" is only the surface of a deeper organizational challenge.

FLAB THEORY: DEEP ANALYSIS

Fear

Worrying about project failure and the resulting executive disappointment.

Limiting Beliefs

A feeling of powerlessness over resource allocation and "fixed" priorities.

Assumptions

Presuming other projects (MB/GM) are inherently higher priority than your own.

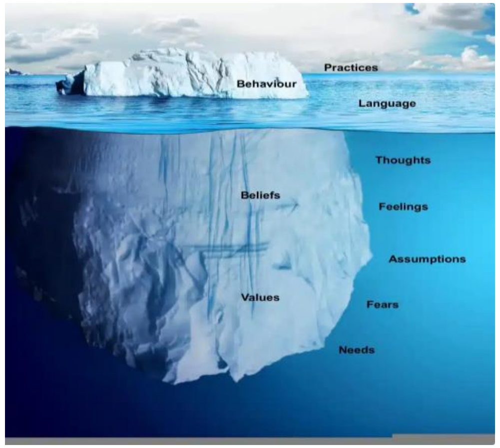
Biases

Falling into a "Us vs. Them" mentality (your project vs. the organization).

THE ICEBERG MODEL

Hidden Drivers: Below the visible delays lie the real catalysts of behavior.

- **Structures:** Unspoken organizational hierarchies and political tensions.
- **Priorities:** Strategic rationale behind MB and GM projects.
- **Mental Models:** The internal FLABs driving your team's reaction.



EMPATHY AS A STRATEGIC TOOL

Upward Empathy

Understand the **Strategic Rationale** of senior management. Why are MB and GM high priority? Aligning with executive business goals creates a path for shared solutions.

Cognitive Empathy

Understand the **Peer Pressures** on other PMs (MB/GM). They face tight deadlines too. Framing as a collaborative solution rather than an adversarial demand wins allies.

VISIONARY & DEMOCRATIC STYLES

Action (Visionary): Articulate the long-term strategic importance of your project to leadership. Show how delays impact the overall company mission.

Action (Democratic): Engage the core team to brainstorm creative alternatives. Empowering them fosters ownership and resilience.

THE STRATEGIC OUTCOME

50%

Resource Restoration

Moving from Inaction to Compromise

By framing project value against strategic priorities, we secured a workable middle ground:

- **Hybrid Capacity:** Critical resource returns at 50% capacity for essential tasks.
- **Contingency Approval:** Temporary contractor budget approved for lower-tier tasks.
- **Alignment:** Team ownership increased through democratic problem-solving.

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Resilient Leadership

THE SITUATION:

- **Navigating the Vector SIP Integration Crisis**
- **4 Days to Release**
- Unexpected integration failures in the Vector package require immediate cognitive intervention.

Mind Mastery: Recognition

Breaking Analysis Paralysis

The first step in crisis is acknowledging the mind's tendency toward "what-ifs." We must pivot from emotional reaction to strategic execution.

- **Focus:** Define the single critical objective.
- **Concentration:** Protect blocks of deep strategy time.
- **Awareness:** Map the impact surface of the Vector bug.

The "War Room" Protocol

Stakeholder Sync

Immediate alignment with Tech Leads, Product, and Vector senior management to establish escalation priority.

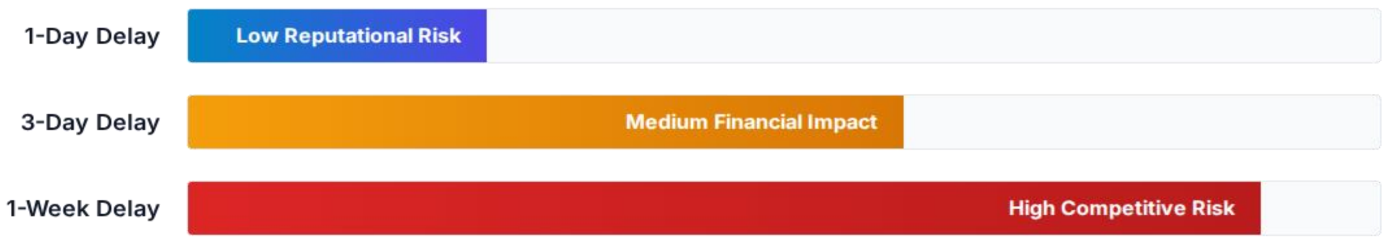
Problem Core

Technical deep-dive to determine if the bug is a total blocker or a "knowable limitation" for version 1.0.

Cognitive Pivot

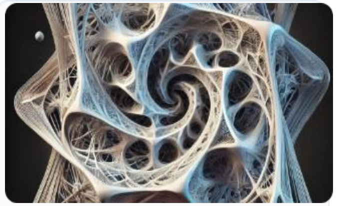
Accepting that the original plan is broken. Reconstructing the mind map to fit the 96-hour reality.

Impact Analysis: Delay Risks



Quantifying trade-offs moves the team from panic to objective assessment.

Strategic Brainstorming



Vector Fix

Push for dedicated resource. Obtain a hard ETA(estimated time of approval) for the official patch delivery.

Internal Patch

Develop a temporary workaround or bypass the affected SIP module for the critical path.

Feature De-scope

Disable the affected feature for launch. Enable via OTA update once the SIP is fixed.

Option Decision Matrix

Option	Feasibility	Risk Factor	Release Impact
Official Vector Fix	Moderate	High (Vendor Reliance)	On-time or 1-day slip
Internal Workaround	Low	Medium (Tech Debt)	On-time (Hotfix later)
Feature De-scoping	High	Low (User Experience)	Strictly On-time
Standard Delay	High	High (Market/PR)	1-Week minimum slip

Mission Critical Horizon

96

HOURS TO LAUNCH

Total Objectives Focus

All non-essential communications are routed to secondary channels. The technical core is shielded from external stakeholder noise.

- 4-Hour Sync with Vector Support
- EOD Stakeholder Transparency
- Real-time QA Regression

Leadership Outcomes

- **Empowered Team:** The transition from victim of circumstance to active problem solver drastically improves morale.
- **Precise Communication:** Vector receives specific requirements rather than general complaints, speeding up resolution.
- **Rational Trade-offs:** The costs of delay vs. de-scoping are understood by all senior leadership.
- **Fatigue Mitigation:** Clear structure reduces the "amorphous stress" of unknown risks.

Uncertainty Management

THE SITUATION:

NAVIGATING ARCHITECTURAL INDECISION

CONTEXT: THE ARCHITECTURAL DEADLOCK

CURRENT SCENARIO

A lack of clear direction between MATLAB and C languages has stalled core development. Interim decisions are perceived as unstable patches, causing developer hesitation and rework risks.

STRATEGIC IMPACT

The indecision ripples through performance requirements, talent acquisition, and integration. Without a standard, planning and skill development remain paralyzed.

THE VUCA CHALLENGE

V - VOLATILITY: A SHIFTING FOUNDATION

- ❖ **Unstable Ground:** Architecture threats shift constantly, creating volatile development progress.
- ❖ **Investment Risk:** Developers hesitate to commit deeply to core architecture for fear of total rework.
- ❖ **Volatile Patches:** Interim choices signal instability rather than progress.

U - UNCERTAINTY: STRATEGIC BLIND SPOTS

UNDEFINED FUTURE STANDARDS

- ❖ Uncertainty regarding MATLAB vs. C impacts every level of planning. The core problem is the absolute lack of predictability about the long-term technical choice and necessary team expertise.

C & A: COMPLEXITY AND AMBIGUITY

COMPLEXITY

Performance, talent availability, build systems, and maintainability create a dense web of interdependencies.

AMBIGUITY

Mixed signals from leadership and internal politics obscure the "why" behind decision delays, fueling team frustration.

RESPONDING WITH VUCA PRIME

V - VISION: PURPOSE OVER VOLATILITY

THE STABLE NORTH STAR

"While the language decision is critical, our vision is to deliver specific customer value. Both MATLAB and C can get us there."

- Re-articulate product goals beyond architecture.
- Focus immediate effort on core value delivery.
- Anchor team morale in strategic importance.

U & C: NAVIGATING UNCERTAINTY WITH INSIGHT

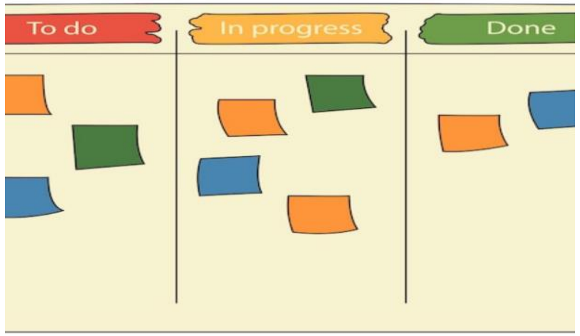
VUCA Factor	Leadership Response (Action)	Direct Team Outcome
Uncertainty	Sense-making meetings & Team input gathering.	Reduced strategic blind spots.
Complexity	Transparent communication & Clear interim directives.	Simplified daily workflows.
Decision Stall	Established explicit decision criteria.	Restored confidence in the path forward.

A - AGILITY: RESILIENCE IN FLUX

PREPARING FOR THE PIVOT

Resilient leaders foster agility by preparing teams for either outcome effectively during the interim period.

- ✓ Proactive C training "Spikes".
- ✓ Highly modular design implementation.
- ✓ Parallel project planning for MATLAB/C.



PATH FORWARD: RESTORING PROGRESS

PHASE 1	PHASE 2	PHASE 3	PHASE 4
Sense-making & stakeholder alignment.	Interim directive communication.	Parallel prototyping & agile training.	Final architecture commitment.

Leading Cross-Functional Team

THE SITUATION:

Navigating the Transition from "Process Hesitancy" to Agile Organizational Excellence

Phase 1: Diagnostic Lens

Understanding initial resistance through Lencioni's framework

LACK OF COMMITMENT

Superficial Adoption

Teams were "going through the motions"—logging timesheets superficially without truly buying into the methodology spirit.

Authentic Buy-in

As trust was built, commitment increased. Teams understood how accurate data led to realistic planning and resource allocation.

ABSENCE OF TRUST

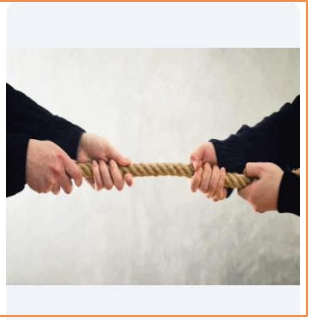
From Suspicion to Vulnerability

- Initially, shift to JIRA with detailed WBS was perceived as micromanagement. **"Are they checking up on us?"**
- Trust was rebuilt by management modeling vulnerability and explaining the "Why"—focusing on unblocking rather than tracking.

FEAR OF CONFLICT

Safety in Healthy Debate

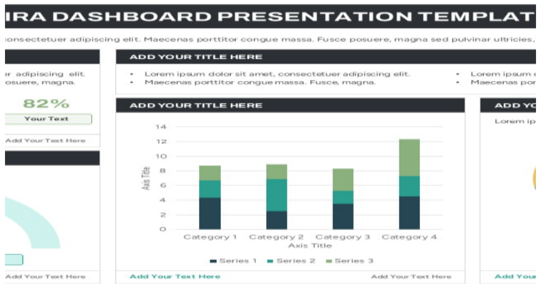
- **Initial Hesitancy:** Fear of providing high estimates or questioning the new Agile methodology.
- **The Pivot:** Creating psychological safety where estimates are seen as tools for learning, not rigid commitments.
- **Outcome:** Constructive retrospectives where challenges are raised without blame.



AVOIDANCE OF ACCOUNTABILITY

Ownership of Outcomes

- In low-trust environments, teams resist being accountable for velocity metrics or burndown charts they perceive as arbitrary.
- With clarity, accountability becomes a shared responsibility. Maintaining accurate data becomes the team's new norm.



INATTENTION TO RESULTS

Individual Silos

Initial focus on individual coding tasks, viewing process as "overhead."

Collective Focus

Connecting process to predictable release cycles and product quality.

Strategic Wins

Diligence in process directly contributing to the organization's overall success.

Phase 2: The Team Canvas

Turning organizational resistance into a force for collective ownership

FORGING PURPOSE

Alignment Over Imposition

❖ The "Team Canvas" session shifts the narrative from external imposition to internal agreement.

❖ Collaboratively defining "Why Agile?" builds the trust necessary to embrace the new processes head-on.

CANVAS CORE PILLARS

Roles & Needs

Clarifying JIRA responsibilities and identifying gaps in training or support.

Values & Purpose

Articulating the positive intent behind changes to ensure psychological safety.

Rules of Engagement

Setting clear norms for ceremonies and "Definition of Done" expectations.

THE FINAL OUTCOME

100%

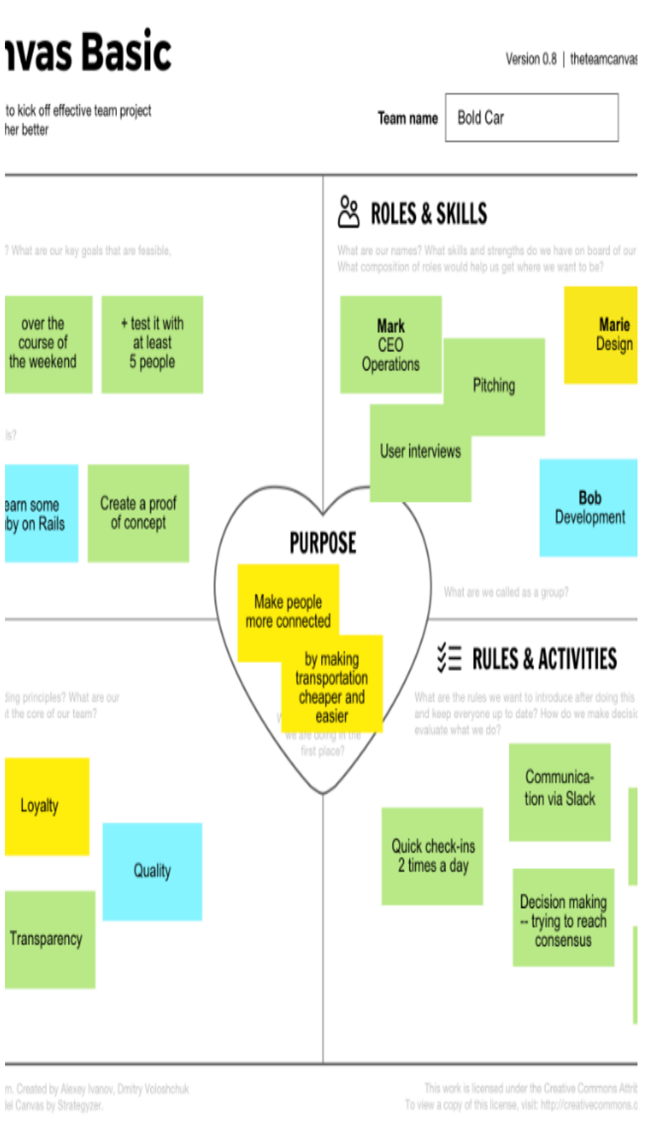
PURPOSE UNDERSTOOD

Measurable Improvement

❖ **Team Cohesion:** A psychologically safe environment with built trust.

❖ **Data Integrity:** Accurate velocity, release, and sprint burndown charts.

❖ **Higher Morale:** Empowerment replaced the feeling of micromanagement.



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Action Plan (Next 30–60 Days)

3 specific actions:

1. Restore project predictability
2. improve team effectiveness
3. enhance collaboration across all stakeholders

How will you measure success?

1. Improved engagement
2. Reduced blockers

Thank You